Music I Love - Personal Notes

Carlos Moore | Updated January 2026

CLASSIC ROCK

Tom Petty is probably my favorite. There is something about the plainness of his lyrics that gets to something true. Bought the Heartbreakers box set in 2023 and listened through the whole thing over two months. Full Moon Fever is the desert island album. Wildflowers is close.

The Eagles are the Saturday morning music. Hotel California, Desperado, Take It Easy. I had the Greatest Hits on cassette as a kid, one of the first albums I ever owned. Now on a streaming app but the feeling is the same.

Artist	Essential Albums	Favorite Song	Seen Live
Tom Petty and the Heartbreakers	Full Moon Fever, Wildflowers	Learning to Fly	Yes, Bridgestone 2017
Eagles	Hotel California, Desperado	Desperado	No, would go
Fleetwood Mac	Rumours	The Chain	No
Bruce Springsteen	Born to Run, Nebraska	Thunder Road	No, one day
Creedence Clearwater Revival	Chronicle Vol 1	Have You Ever Seen the Rain	No

COUNTRY

Chris Stapleton is the real thing. Tennessee Whiskey put him on most people's radar but Traveller is the album. Saw him at the Ryman in 2022 and it was one of the best concerts I have been to. Maria cried at Broken Halos.

Zach Bryan came out of nowhere and then was everywhere. I resisted for a while and then American Heartbreak got me. He writes like someone who has actually lived something.

Artist	Essential Albums	Favorite Song	Seen Live
Chris Stapleton	Traveller, Starting Over	Broken Halos	Yes, Ryman 2022
Zach Bryan	American Heartbreak	I Remember Everything	No, would go
Kacey Musgraves	Golden Hour	Rainbow	No
Tyler Childers	Purgatory, Long Violent History	Feathered Indians	No
Luke Combs	What You See Is What You Get	Beautiful Crazy	No

SMOOTH JAZZ - WEEKEND MORNINGS

Saturday and Sunday mornings before anyone else is up. Coffee is brewing, the house is quiet. A weekend jazz playlist, or sometimes a dedicated Kenny G or Grover Washington Jr. station. This is the music that reminds me of my father. He played it in the car every Sunday morning driving to church.

Artist	Go-To Album	Context
Kenny G	Breathless	Morning coffee, year-round
Grover Washington Jr.	Winelight	Sunday mornings especially
Dave Koz	Lucky Man	Background for easy Sundays
Najee	Tokyo Blue	Reminds me of the 90s, good energy
Norman Brown	Better Days Ahead	Afternoons working from home

GOSPEL AND CHURCH MUSIC

The Calvary Hill choir sings traditional gospel, some contemporary gospel, and a few hymns every week. I have been in this choir for 11 years. The music I sing on Sunday is different from what I listen to at home, but it is the music I know most deeply. Kirk Franklin and Hezekiah Walker for contemporary. Thomas Dorsey for the roots.

CONCERTS ATTENDED - NOTABLE

Artist	Venue	Year	With
Tom Petty and the Heartbreakers	Bridgestone Arena, Nashville	2017	Maria and Tanya
Chris Stapleton	Ryman Auditorium	2022	Maria
Eagles	Bridgestone Arena	2019	Maria and Raymond
Zach Bryan (tickets from Jalen)	American Airlines Center, Dallas	-	We did not go, scheduling conflict